

CURRICULUM VITAE

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

I earned my PhD in **Pharmaceutical Outcomes and Policy Research** from the University of Pittsburgh in 2024 and currently serve as a postdoctoral scholar at the University of California, San Diego. My research leverages real-world data and advanced quantitative methods to optimize medication use in **cardiovascular and metabolic diseases**. My research applies a broad range of statistical approaches, including machine learning, trajectory modeling, time-series analyses, and time-varying survival analysis. My research work has culminated in **fifteen peer-reviewed publications, including ten as first or senior author**. As a postdoctoral scholar, I am expanding my research to focus on **drug safety in patients with chronic conditions, incorporating novel considerations around socioeconomic factors and environmental stressors** within pharmacoepidemiology. **I am currently supported by an American Diabetes Association postdoctoral fellowship** that leverages Medicare data to examine the safety of medication use among individuals with type 2 diabetes in the context of extreme heat, air pollution exposure, and neighborhood-level disadvantage.

My long-term goal is to become an independent investigator leading a research program focused on medication safety in patients with chronic diseases. Specifically, I am interested in applying **pharmacoepidemiologic methods to detect drug–drug interactions** and to evaluate **how these risks may interact with clinical, social, and environmental stressors to influence health outcomes**. My work aims to generate real-world evidence that informs the safe, equitable, and personalized use of medications in vulnerable populations. In 2024, I submitted a NIDDK K99 proposal with reviewer feedback returned in May 2025 (score 40). This project examines how the use of certain medications known to affect thermoregulation may affect the risk of adverse outcomes when vulnerable populations with cardiovascular or metabolic disease are exposed to extreme temperatures, highlighting the public health relevance of environmental pharmacoepidemiology.

EDUCATION

PhD in Pharmaceutical Outcomes and Policy Research

Apr 2024

School of Pharmacy, University of Pittsburgh

- Dissertation: Effectiveness and Safety Outcomes of SGLT2 Inhibitors in Type 2 Diabetes and Use of Drugs with Nephrotoxic Potential
- Advisors: Levent Kirisci, PhD; Inmaculada Hernandez, PharmD, PhD

MPH in Epidemiology

May 2019

Graduate School of Public Health, University of Pittsburgh

- Essay: Real-world Direct Comparison of the Effectiveness and Safety of Apixaban, Dabigatran, Rivaroxaban, and Warfarin in Medicare Beneficiaries with Atrial Fibrillation: A Subgroup Analyses by a History of Ischemic Stroke or Transient Ischemic Attack
- Advisor: Nancy W Glynn, PhD

BS in Clinical Pharmacy

Jul 2017

School of Pharmacy, Harbin Medical University

APPOINTMENTS AND POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Scholar	University of California San Diego	May 2024 - Present
- Served as the principal investigator and lead in a study funded by the Skaggs Family Foundation evaluating the impact of exposure to wildfire smoke and extreme heat on adverse health outcomes in Medicare beneficiaries. - Led analysis for an R01 grant evaluating trajectories of telehealth visits among patients with cardiovascular disease after the COVID-19 pandemic.		
Graduate Student Researcher	University of Pittsburgh	Jul 2022 - Apr 2024
- Conducted analysis for an R01 grant on the COVID-19 pandemic disruptions of chronic disease management in a cohort of over 500,000 participants utilizing Optum and Medicare claims data. - Executed diverse statistical analysis plans, utilizing methods including interrupted time-series analysis and Cox proportional hazard models with time-dependent variables.		
Data Scientist Intern	Omada Health	Jul 2023 - Oct 2023
- Drafted statistical analysis plans, performed data cleaning, and conducted a difference-in-difference analysis. - Assisted in code review and enhanced SQL codes for improved efficiency. Collaborated with cross-functional teams, optimizing study design decisions, research outcomes, and scientific communication.		
Teaching Assistant	University of Pittsburgh	Sep 2019 - Dec 2022
- Instructed weekly statistical recitation sessions for a class of 40 students, teaching them on various statistical models and key concepts, using SAS, Stata, and R. - Facilitated practicum sessions, instructing students through the process of analyzing real-world data and assessing patients' outcomes using statistical methods.		
Research Assistant	University of Pittsburgh	Apr 2018 - Sep 2018
- Led a comparative effectiveness and safety study of oral anticoagulation treatments using Medicare claims data, from study design to interpretation of results. - First-authored the manuscript reporting study findings and presented results at the American Heart Association scientific session.		

HONORS AND AWARDS

1. M-PACT Rising Scholar, University of Michigan M-PACT Future Conference, June 2025.
2. International Society of Pharmacoepidemiology (ISPE) Scholarship, Aug 2023.
3. International Society of Pharmacoepidemiology (ISPE) Annual Meeting 2023 Spotlight Abstract (abstract title: Cardiovascular Risk and Safety of SGLT2 Inhibitors vs DPP-4 Inhibitors: A Nationwide Comparative Effectiveness Research Study), Aug 2023.
4. Memorial Prize, University of Pittsburgh School of Pharmacy Three-Minute Dissertation, Apr 2023.
5. The Professional Society for Health Economics and Outcomes Research (ISPOR) Europe Annual Meeting 2020 Top Poster (poster title: *Machine Learning to Identify Diabetes Patients with Canagliflozin Prescriptions at High-Risk of Lower Extremity Amputation Using Real-World Data*), Dec 2020.
6. Travel Grant, Graduate School of Public Health, University of Pittsburgh, Jan 2019.

7. College Second-class Scholarship (ranking in the top 2% of the class), Harbin Medical University, Aug 2016 and Aug 2014.

RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

PUBLICATIONS

1. Qian H, Hernandez I, **Yang L**. Predictors of Discontinuation of Angiotensin Converting Enzyme Inhibitors Use Among Medicare Beneficiaries Using Sodium-Glucose Cotransporter 2 Inhibitors. *Pharmacoepidemiol Drug Saf*. 2026. In press.
2. **Yang L**, Tang S, Guo J, Gabriel N, Fendrick AM, Patel N, Essien UR, Magnani JW, Gellad WF, Hernandez I. Trends in Outpatient Care Utilization for Patients with Established Atrial Fibrillation Before and After the Covid-19 Pandemic: A Nationwide Analysis of Claims Data. *BMC Res Notes* 18, 499 (2025). doi: <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13104-025-07569-6>.
3. Huang W, Kimmel S, Ahmed M, Smith S, Lee Y, **Yang L**, Hernandez I, Bian J, Guo J External Exposome Factors and Adverse Heart Failure Outcomes in the OneFlorida+ Network: Retrospective Cohort Study *JMIR Form Res* 2025;9:e71595. doi:10.2196/71595.
4. **Yang L**, Guo J, Kane-Gill SL, Gabriel N, Empey K, Suh K, Kirisci L, Hernandez I. Use of Potentially Nephrotoxic Drugs in Type 2 Diabetes Patients on SGLT2i: A Trajectories Analysis. *Pharmacoepidemiol Drug Saf*. 2025. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1002/pds.70098>.
5. **Yang L**, Tang S, Guo J, Gabriel N, Gellad WF, Essien UR, Magnani JW, Hernandez I. COVID-19 Diagnosis, Oral Anticoagulation, and Stroke Risk in Patients with Atrial Fibrillation. *Am J Cardiovasc Drugs*. 2024. 24, 693–702 doi: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40256-024-00671-3>.
6. Chen W, Li Y, Chen A, Allen J, Guo Y, Bilello LA, Smith S, **Yang L**, Goodin A, Bian J, Guo J. Social Determinants of Health and Newer Glucose-lowering Drugs Adoption among US Medicare Beneficiaries with Type 2 Diabetes. *J Manag Care Spec Pharm*. 2024. doi: <https://doi.org/10.18553/jmcp.2024.30.11.1298>.
7. Hernandez I, **Yang L**, Tang S, Cameron T, Guo J, Gabriel N, Essien UR, Magnani JW, Gellad WF. COVID-19 pandemic and trends in clinical outcomes and medication use for patients with established atrial fibrillation: A nationwide analysis of claims data. *Am Heart J Plus*. 2024;42:100396. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ahjo.2024.100396>.
8. Huang W, Ahmed MM, Smith S, Morris EJ, **Yang L**, O'Neal L, Hernandez I, Bian J, Kimmel SE, Guo J. Trajectories of Sacubitril/Valsartan Adherence Among Medicare Beneficiaries with Heart Failure. *JACC-Advance* 2024, 100958. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jacadv.2024.100958>.
9. Chen W, Li Y, **Yang L**, Allen J, Shao H, Donahoo W, Hu X, Shenkman E, Bian J, Smith S, Guo J. Geographic Variation and Racial Disparities in Newer Glucose-lowering Drugs Adoption among US Medicare Beneficiaries with Type 2 Diabetes. *PLoS One*. 2024;19(1):e0297208. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0297208>.
10. **Yang L**, Tang S, He M, Guo J, Gabriel N, Swabe G, Gellad WF, Essien UR, Saba S, Benjamin EJ, Magnani JW, Hernandez I. COVID-19 pandemic and initiation of treatment for atrial fibrillation: a nationwide analysis of claims data. *BMC Cardiovasc Disord*. 2023 23, 604. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12872-023-03614-z>.
11. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Bian J, Biello LA, Wright GR, Hernandez I, Guo J. Individual and Social Determinants of Adherence to Sodium Glucose Cotransporter 2 Inhibitor Therapy: A Trajectory Analysis. *J Manag Care Spec Pharm*. 2023. doi: <https://doi.org/10.18553/jmcp.2023.29.11.1242>.
12. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Hernandez I, Vouri SM, Kimmel SE, Bian J, Guo J. Identifying patients at risk of acute kidney injury among Medicare beneficiaries with type 2 diabetes initiating SGLT2 inhibitors: a machine learning approach. *Front Pharmacol*. 2022 Mar (13):834743. doi: <https://doi.org/10.3389/fphar.2022.834743>.
13. **Yang L**, Guo J, Liang Q, Newman TV, Gellad WF, Hernandez I. Primary care provider payment models and adherence to anticoagulation in patients with atrial fibrillation. *J Manag Care Spec Pharm*. 2021 Dec;27(12):1672-1679. doi: <https://doi.org/10.18553/jmcp.2021.27.12.1672>.

14. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Hernandez I, Winterstein AG, Guo J. Using machine learning to identify diabetes patients with canagliflozin prescriptions at high-risk of lower extremity amputation using real-world data. *Pharmacoepidemiol Drug Saf.* 2021 Feb 30(6):644-651. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1002/pds.5206>.
15. **Yang L**, Brooks MM, Glynn NW, Zhang Y, Saba S, Hernandez I. Real-World Direct Comparison of the Effectiveness and Safety of Apixaban, Dabigatran, Rivaroxaban, and Warfarin in Medicare Beneficiaries with Atrial Fibrillation. *Am J Cardiol.* 2020 Mar;(126):29-36. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.amjcard.2020.03.034>.

RESEARCH FUNDING

Active

1. Polypharmacy, Environmental Exposures, and Social Disadvantage in Type 2 Diabetes. Funding agency: American Diabetes Association. Role: Principal Investigator. Direct costs: \$271,732. Funding Period: 1/1/2026-12/31/2028.

Past

1. Effect of Extreme Heat and Wildfire Smoke on Health Outcomes and Costs in Vulnerable Populations with Cardiovascular Disease in the Western US: A Geospatial Analysis. Funding agency: Skaggs Family Foundation. Role: Multiple Principal Investigator. Direct costs: \$149,103. Funding Period: 7/1/2023- 12/31/2025.

INVITED PRESENTATION

1. Real-World Insights into Clinical and Pharmaceutical Outcomes of Sodium Glucose Cotransporter 2 Inhibitors. Invited Presentation at the CHOICE Institute's PHEnOM seminar series, February 5, 2025.
2. SGLT2 inhibitors, Drugs with Nephrotoxic Potential and Kidney Outcomes in Diabetes: An Analysis of Real-World Data. Invited Presentation at ISOP's North American Chapter June Meeting, June 25, 2024.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS AND ABSTRACTS

1. **Yang L**, Hernandez I, Gabriel N, Tang S, Crater L, Blackburn H, Page Ii RL. Risk of Hospitalization in Patients with Heart Failure Exposed to Extreme Heat and Poor Air Quality in the Western United States. Poster Presentation at American Heart Association 2025 Scientific Session. New Orleans LA, Nov7-10. Published in *Circulation* 152(Suppl_3) AP4364346.
2. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Tang S, Cater L, Blackburn H, Page Ii RL, Saba S, Hernandez I. Increased Risk of Hospitalization in Patients with Atrial Fibrillation Exposed to High Particulate Matter. Spotlight Session Poster Presentation at ICPE 2025, Washington, DC, August 22-26, 2025.
3. **Yang L**, Tang S, Guo J, Gabriel N, Fendrick AM, Patel N, Essien UR, Magnani JW, Gellad WF, Hernandez I. Changes in Outpatient Care Utilization Among Medicare Beneficiaries with Atrial Fibrillation Following the Covid-19 Pandemic. Poster Presentation at ICPE 2025, Washington DC, August 22-26, 2025.
4. Qian H, Hernandez I, **Yang L**. Predictors of Discontinuation of Angiotensin Converting Enzyme Inhibitors Use Among Medicare Beneficiaries Using Sodium-Glucose Cotransporter 2 Inhibitors. Poster Presentation at 2024 ACCP Annual Meeting, Phoenix, Arizona, October 12-15, 2024.
5. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Guo J, Empey K, Suh K, Kane-Gill SL, Kirisci L, Hernandez I. Cardiovascular Risk and Safety of SGLT2 Inhibitors vs DPP-4 Inhibitors: A Nationwide Comparative Effectiveness Research Study. Spotlight Session Poster at ICPE 2023 Conference Spotlight Session, Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada, August 25-28, 2023.
6. **Yang L**, Tang S, He M, Guo J, Gabriel N, Swabe G, Gellad WF, Essien UR, Saba S, Benjamin EJ, Magnani JW, Hernandez I. Trends in Initiation of Anticoagulation for Atrial Fibrillation in the Early Months of the Covid-19 Pandemic. Poster Presentation at the EPI | Lifestyle 2023 Scientific Sessions, February 28-March 3, 2023 Boston, Massachusetts. Published in *Circulation* 147(Suppl_1) AP541.

7. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Hernandez I, Guo J. Group Based Trajectory Models to Identify Adherence Pattern to Sodium Glucose Cotransporter 2 Inhibitors Among Type 2 Diabetes Patients. Virtual Poster Presentation at 2021 Virtual ISPOR Europe, November 30- December 3, 2021. Published in Value in Health 2022;25(1):S138.
8. **Yang L**, Newman TV, Guo J, Gellad WF, Hernandez I. Association between Primary Care Provider Payment Models and Adherence to Anticoagulation in a Sample of Patients with Atrial Fibrillation, Virtual Poster Presentation at ISPE 2021 Conference, August 23-25, 2021. Published in Pharmacoepidemiol Drug Saf 2021;30(S1):3-400.
9. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Hernandez I, Winterstein AG, Kimmel SG, Guo J. Machine Learning to Identify Diabetes Patients Initiating SGLT2i at High-risk of Acute Kidney Injury. Virtual Poster Presentation at 2021 American Diabetes Association's 81st Scientific Session (Online meeting), June 25-29, 2021. Published in Diabetes 2021; 70 (S1): doi.org/10.2337/db21-782-P
10. **Yang L**, Gabriel N, Hernandez I, Guo J. Machine Learning to Identify Diabetes Patients with Canagliflozin Prescriptions at High-Risk of Lower Extremity Amputation Using Real-World Data. Virtual poster presentation at 2020 ISPOR Europe (Online meeting). November 14, 2020. Published in Value in Health 2020;23(S2):S532.
11. **Yang L**, Saba S, Zhang Y, Hernandez I. Real-world Direct Comparison of the Effectiveness and Safety of Apixaban, Dabigatran, Rivaroxaban, and Warfarin in Medicare Beneficiaries with Fibrillation: A Subgroup Analyses by a History of Ischemic Stroke. Poster Presentation at American Heart Association Fellows Research Day 2019. Pittsburgh, PA. January 18, 2019.
12. **Yang L**, Saba S, Zhang Y, Hernandez I. Real-world Direct Comparison of the Effectiveness and Safety of Apixaban, Dabigatran, Rivaroxaban, and Warfarin in Medicare Beneficiaries with Fibrillation: A Subgroup Analyses by a History of Ischemic Stroke. Poster Presentation at American Heart Association 2018 Scientific Session. Chicago, IL. November 10, 2018. Published in Circulation 2018;138:A14203.

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Year	Course Number, Title, Course Level	Key Words of the Course
2022	Pharm 2022, Patient Reported Outcome and Adherence, PharmD	Medication safety, Adherence
2021	Pharm 3074, Applied Multivariate Statistical Analysis in Pharmaceutical Sciences, Graduate-level	Multivariate statistical methods
2021	Pharm 5324, Case conference series 5, PharmD (P3)	Patient care, Communication
2021	Pharm 5218, Pharmacokinetics and drug response, PharmD (P2)	Pharmacokinetics
2020	Pharm 5220, Case conference series 3, PharmD (P2)	Patient assessment
2020	Pharm 3040, Statistical Methods, Graduate-level	Biostatistics, Research methods
2019	Pharm 5216, Pharmacotherapy of Cardiovascular Disease, PharmD (P1)	Pharmacology, Physiology

MENTORING AND ADVISING

Year	Student's Name (Program)	Role
2024 - 2025	Hongjie Qian (MS in Biostatistics, UC San Diego Herbert Wertheim School of Public Health and Human Longevity Science)	Research Mentor
2022	Wenxi Huang (MS in Pharmaceutical Outcomes and Policy, University of Florida College of Pharmacy)	Research Mentor

SERVICE
REVIEWER

Journal Reviewer (year of reviewing)

American Heart Journal (2024)
 American Journal of Cardiovascular Drugs (2024)
 Alzheimer's & Dementia (2024)
 BMC Geriatrics (2024,2026)
 BMC Health Service Research (2026)
 BMC Medical Research Methodology (2025)
 Cardiovascular Diabetology (2024)
 Diabetes, Obesity and Metabolism (2024, 2025)
 Drugs & Aging (2024, 2025)
 European Journal of Clinical Pharmacology (2026)
 JAMA Internal Medicine (2025,2026)
 JAMA Network Open (2026)
 JAMIA open (2025,2026)
 Journal of the American Heart Association (2024)
 Journal of Thrombosis and Thrombolysis (2024)
 Naunyn-Schmiedeberg's Archives of Pharmacology (2025)
 Npj Cardiovascular Health (2024)
 Pharmacoepidemiology and Drug Safety (2025)
 PLOS One (2024)
 Scientific Reports (2025)
 The International Journal of Health Planning and Management (2023)

Abstract Reviewer (year of reviewing)

Academy of Managed Care Pharmacy Nexus 2025 (2024)
 Academy of Managed Care Pharmacy Nexus 2024 (2024)
 American Public Health Association (APHA) Annual Meeting (2025)
 Annual Pharmaceutical Sciences Research Symposium (2021)
 International Society for Pharmacoepidemiology (ISPE) Asian Conference on Pharmacoepidemiology (2025)